

COLLECTION · SELLERS

Photos, Video and Marketing

*Selling in the digital age — the first showing
happens online*

READ BEFORE YOU BEGIN

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Photos, Video and Marketing

Selling in the digital age — the first showing happens online

Today, the first visit to your property happens on a screen. Quality photos and marketing determine who books a viewing — and who moves on. Marketing isn't a luxury: it's what fills your showings.

This guide covers photos, video, the description and distribution, to maximize attention and attract the right buyers.

Each chapter ends with a lined “My notes” page.

Today, a sale is won first online: photos, video, description and distribution decide whether the buyer clicks or scrolls past. This guide covers every marketing lever, from preparing the space to reaching the right audience.

The principle: tend to the digital storefront as much as the property itself.

CHAPTER

Photos: your digital storefront

Understanding why photos make (or break) the sale.

Buyers judge your property in a few seconds from the photos. Bright, sharp, well-framed images generate more clicks, more visits and better offers. Dark or amateur photos do the opposite, even for a beautiful property.

- Professional photos: light, controlled wide-angle, a prepared property (staging).
- A logical order and a strong lead photo (often the façade or the feature room).
- Enough of them: show all the key rooms without misleading.

Buyers judge in a few seconds, on the photos, before they even read the description. Professional, bright, well-framed photos make the difference between “let's visit” and “skip”. It's the most profitable marketing investment of a sale.

EMILIE'S TIP

Never skimp on photos: it's the highest-return investment of the entire sale. A well-prepared, poorly photographed property sells for less than it should.

CHAPTER

Video and the virtual tour

Going beyond the photo to stand out.

Video and the virtual tour (3D tour, floor plans) let buyers picture themselves before travelling. They attract serious buyers, including those coming from farther away, and filter out less relevant visits.

- A short, dynamic video showcasing the flow and the atmosphere.
- A virtual tour to explore at one's own pace.
- A floor plan to understand the volumes.

Video and the virtual tour (3D, floor plans) let buyers picture themselves and filter before travelling: you get more qualified visitors. For out-of-area buyers, it's often what triggers the first in-person visit.

EMILIE'S TIP

Video tells the atmosphere and lifestyle that a photo freezes. For a property with strong character (view, layout, area), it's a powerful trigger of emotion and visits.

CHAPTER

The description that makes people want in

Writing copy that sells without misleading.

- Open on asset #1 (location, light, renovation, yard).
- Describe the spaces concretely and the benefits (not just dimensions).
- Mention the neighbourhood and its amenities.
- Stay honest: a misleading description creates disappointed visits and offers that fall through.

A good description opens on asset #1 (location, light, renovation, yard), describes concretely without exaggerating, and ends with a call to action. It sells without misleading: promising what you can't deliver generates disappointed visits and offers that collapse.

EMILIE'S TIP

Sell the benefits, not just the features: not “a 12-foot kitchen”, but “a light-filled kitchen made for entertaining”. The buyer buys a life, not dimensions.

CHAPTER

Distribution: being seen by the right buyers

Maximizing exposure to the right audience.

- Wide distribution: Centris, portals, social media, the broker network.
- Targeting: putting the property in front of the area's active buyers.
- Launch momentum: concentrating exposure in the first weeks, when interest is highest.
- Sign, open houses and QR codes to also capture local buyers.

A large part of a broker's value lies in this network and distribution machine, hard to replicate on your own.

Distribution must aim wide AND accurately: Centris, portals, social media, the network of contacts and buyers. A beautiful property poorly distributed sells poorly; exposure to the right audience is as important as the quality of the visuals.

EMILIE'S TIP

Tend to the launch: focus the marketing energy on the first two weeks. That's the window when interest is strongest and where your best offers often play out.

CHAPTER

Before the camera: preparing the space

Successful photos start with preparation.

The best photos won't rescue a poorly prepared property. Before the shoot:

- **Declutter** and tidy every room.
- **Clean** thoroughly (surfaces, windows, floors).
- Maximize the **light**: curtains open, bulbs on.
- Put away **personal** items and signs of daily life (dishes, products).
- Tend to the **exterior** and the entrance for the first photo.

A spotless property produces images that make people want to visit — and that's the whole point.

The best photos won't rescue a poorly prepared property: declutter, clean thoroughly, maximize the light and put away personal items BEFORE the shoot. Treat photo day like the visit of a demanding buyer — it's your first impression online, and there's only one.

EMILIE'S TIP

Treat photo day like a demanding buyer's visit: everything must be tidy, clean and bright. The photos are your first impression online, and there's only one.

IN PRACTICE

Action plan

Your next steps, concretely.

This week

1. Prepare the property for professional photos.
2. Decide whether a video/virtual tour is worthwhile.

Within 30 days

1. Write a benefit-focused, honest description.
2. Plan wide distribution and a concentrated launch.

Next

1. Measure interest (clicks, visits) and adjust as needed.

Before going live

1. Prepare the space, then plan professional photos (and video).
2. Write a description that opens on asset #1 and plan wide distribution.

REFERENCES

Resources & glossary

- Professional photos: bright, sharp images, prepared through staging.
 - Virtual tour: remote 3D exploration of the property.
 - Benefit-focused description: copy that sells a lifestyle, honestly.
 - Distribution: Centris, portals, social media, the broker network.
 - Launch momentum: concentrating exposure in the first weeks.
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- Centris: the reference platform for properties for sale in Quebec.
 - Virtual tour: a 3D walkthrough allowing a remote visit.
 - Digital curb appeal: photo quality that makes people want to visit.
 - Call to action: a clear invitation to visit or make an offer.
 - Distribution: exposing the listing to the right audience of buyers.

GOING FURTHER

Quiz — test your knowledge

1. The first visit to a property today happens:

- A) In person
- B) Online, on a screen
- C) At the notary
- D) By phone

2. The highest-return investment of the sale is:

- A) A new kitchen
- B) Professional photos
- C) A golden sign
- D) Nothing

3. Video and the virtual tour:

- A) Scare people off
- B) Help the buyer picture themselves and filter visits
- C) Are forbidden
- D) Replace the notary

4. A good description sells:

- A) Dimensions only
- B) Benefits, honestly
- C) Lies
- D) The neighbour

5. A misleading description leads to:

- A) Better offers
- B) Disappointed visits and offers that collapse
- C) More trust
- D) Nothing

6. Distribution should be:

- A) Minimal
- B) Wide and targeted at the right buyers
- C) Secret
- D) Reserved for the neighbours

7. The strongest momentum is:

- A) After a year
- B) In the first weeks of the launch
- C) In winter only
- D) Never

8. A big part of a broker's value lies in:

- A) Their sign
- B) Their network and distribution machine
- C) Their car
- D) Nothing

Answer key

- 1. **B** — The photos decide the visits (ch. 1).
- 2. **B** — They generate clicks, visits and offers (ch. 1).
- 3. **B** — They attract serious buyers (ch. 2).
- 4. **B** — You sell a life, not figures (ch. 3).
- 5. **B** — Honesty protects the transaction (ch. 3).
- 6. **B** — You maximize useful exposure (ch. 4).
- 7. **B** — You concentrate the effort there (ch. 4).
- 8. **B** — Hard to replicate on your own (ch. 4).

Signé PAR Em

*Thank you for reading. May this guide help you
decide with confidence, with all the information
in hand.*

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